

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Micro-Project

PHASE 4 | PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

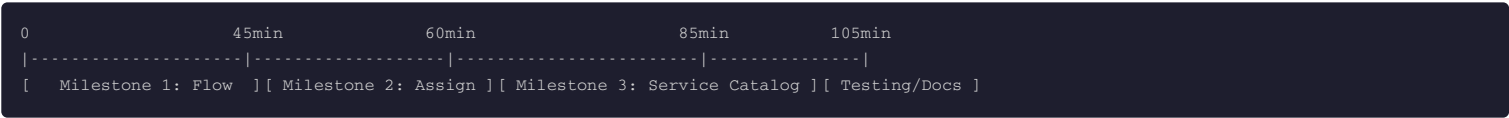
4. Project Planning Phase

4.1 Project Timeline

The project is organized into three milestones, mirroring the task-initiation structure of the lab: building the Flow, assigning it to the catalog item, and validating it through the Service Catalog.

#	Milestone	Key Activities	Est. Duration
1	Milestone 1 — Flow	Create the "Standard Laptop task" Flow; configure Service Catalog trigger; add the Create Catalog Task action with field mapping; activate the flow	45 min
2	Milestone 2 — Flow assignment	Open the Standard Laptop catalog item; clear old automations; bind the new Flow via the Process Engine tab	15 min
3	Milestone 3 — Service Catalog	Place a test order, approve the request, and verify the auto-generated Catalog Task	25 min
4	Testing & Documentation	Capture output screens, validate field values, compile project report	20 min

4.2 Milestone Chart



4.3 Resource Plan

Resource	Role in Project
ServiceNow Developer Instance	Hosting environment for Flow Designer, Service Catalog, and Catalog Task configuration
Flow Designer	Low-code tool used to build the "Standard Laptop task" automation
Standard Laptop catalog item	Existing catalog item that the flow is attached to via Process Engine
Hardware assignment group	Receives the auto-generated Catalog Task
Test requester / Approver accounts	Used to place and approve a live test request

4.4 Dependencies

- The Flow (Milestone 1) must be fully built and Activated before it can be assigned to the catalog item (Milestone 2).
- The catalog item's Process Engine assignment (Milestone 2) must be saved before a test order (Milestone 3) will trigger the new Flow.
- The Hardware assignment group must already exist in the instance before the flow's field mapping can reference it.
- End-to-end testing depends on having a valid approver available to action the request.

4.5 Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Flow not Activated after save	Medium	High	Explicit "Activate" confirmation step included at the end of Milestone 1
Old Workflow/Execution Plan still bound to the catalog item	Medium	High	Milestone 2 explicitly instructs removing existing automations before adding the Flow
Incorrect trigger (not Service Catalog)	Low	High	Trigger type is fixed and documented in the design phase (3.2)
Field values (Assignment group / Approval) left blank	Low	Medium	Field mapping table (3.3) defines every value before build starts
Approver unavailable during testing	Low	Medium	Use an admin/test account with approval rights for the demo request

4.6 Success Criteria

- The "Standard Laptop task" Flow is Active and correctly triggers on new Service Catalog requests for the Standard Laptop item.
- Placing and approving a Standard Laptop request automatically creates a Catalog Task.
- The generated Catalog Task has Short Description/Description = "Laptop needs to Configured", Assignment group = "Hardware", and Approval = "Approved" without any manual edits.
- The Catalog Task is visible and traceable under the originating Requested Item's "Catalog Tasks" related list.

The plan sequences work so the automation is fully built and activated before it is wired into the live catalog item, and reserves a dedicated end-to-end testing step to confirm the entire order-to-task lifecycle behaves as designed.